

IV INVITATION TO PARTICIPATE IN THE SELECTION OF THREE SITUATED RESEARCH PROJECTS AS PART OF THE ANNUAL MEDIALAB MATADERO PROGRAM AT MATADERO MADRID 2025-2026

1.- PRESENTATION:

Madrid City Council directly manages the Matadero Madrid cultural centre through the municipal corporate entity Madrid Destino, Cultura, Turismo y Negocio S.A. (hereinafter, "Madrid Destino") with Tax ID (CIF) number A-84073105, and registered office at Calle Conde Duque 9- 11 (28015 Madrid).

Matadero Madrid, as a centre for contemporary creation, includes Medialab Matadero as one of its programs.

Medialab Matadero promotes multidisciplinary, collaborative, and open research, fostering the development of research projects with both national and international reach. Medialab Matadero aims to establish itself as a cutting-edge research centre shaping the future. Therefore, the fourth edition of the Annual Research Projects Program is presented with an open international invitation to participate. The program will host, support, and showcase the development of three research projects able to explore the relationships between contemporary art, design, science, technology and society in an innovative way, particularly at the edges of classic academic spheres and in the interstitial spaces between established disciplines.

Medialab Matadero promotes research projects that are grounded in the principle of learning by doing. These projects are collaborative and experimental by nature, yet also rigorous, critical and functional. Despite using highly diverse languages, registers and methods, they share the same objectives, which are in line with the most significant trends in artistic research and critical technology. These include exploring emerging socio-technical landscapes, helping to solve urgent problems, and testing socially and ecologically useful solutions through unconventional methods ranging from the speculative to the seemingly counter-intuitive.

Medialab Matadero is an innovation and research space welcoming projects that are too exceptional to fit into the strict lines of academic research, often unable to amalgamate and intertwine diverse disciplines or intermediate positions between thought and practice. Medialab Matadero's mission is to address this institutional gap as much as possible by welcoming and promoting ideas and projects that, despite their brilliance and transformative capacity, do not find their place in more disciplinary public programs.

Within this broad framework, Medialab Matadero provides the context and appropriate space for the development of three research projects throughout the 2025-2026 period through this invitation to participate.

2.- OBJECTIVE:

This invitation to participate, in accordance with the principles of transparency, equality, and competition, and in line with the programming lines of Matadero Madrid, aims to select three research projects to be developed over a maximum period of one year. These projects will engage in dialogue with the activities of Medialab Matadero's annual program and its associated communities.

3.- PARTICIPANTS:

This invitation to participate is aimed at individuals or groups who conduct research in fields related to design, art, architecture, urban planning, economics, film, photography, journalism, digital media, environmental sciences, philosophy, engineering, social studies, political science, digital tool programming, material sciences, activism, or any other field that sheds new light on the chosen themes.

Participants will be expected to contribute to the creation of an open space for personal and professional exchange with Medialab Matadero's local and international audiences, learning communities, and professional and academic circles as well as with the city of Madrid in general. As a result, the working languages will be both Spanish and English.

Project leaders must be of legal age, capable of acting, and in possession of the necessary administrative authorizations to stay in Spain during the research project, and must not be subject to any of the prohibitions on contracting established in Article 71 of the Public Sector Contracts Law.

Any candidate who has an employment or any other current relationship with Madrid Destino will not be eligible to participate.

4. - RESEARCH PROJECT

Submitted projects must adhere to a series of fundamental guidelines:

- Thematic coherence.

In general terms, projects should explore the possible intersections between art, design, science and technology and their results or methods should creatively contribute to addressing major contemporary urban and global challenges within the framework of the Sustainable Development Goals of the 2030 Agenda.

- In particular, all submitted projects should engage with the lines of work of Medialab Matadero, which include all the themes addressed in the annual programmes Lab 1: Sentient Media, Lab 2: The Metabolic Sublime, Lab 3: Synthetic Minds and Lab 4: Weird Futures, with the aim of updating and further exploring the lines of research opened up by Medialab in recent years.

- Innovation and critical reflection.

Developing a cultural project of critical reflection that contributes to a better digital future, tracking the digital revolution at all scales and its impact on society.

- Dialogue.

The project must be able to engage in dialogue with the rest of Medialab's activities. It should also be capable of transformation and enrichment through this dialogue in contact with partners (individuals and other organisations), other researchers, users, and the public.

- Initiation of the research process:

Carry out documentation tasks, as well as activities relating to learning, dissemination and public feedback. When the research is complete, an event must be held at Matadero to present the findings.

The project may be presented and written in either Spanish or English.

Madrid Destino will cover the costs of all learning, dissemination and public feedback activities proposed by the project and approved by the Head of Programming at Medialab Matadero, in line with Medialab's budget.

5.- SELECTION COMMITTEE AND EVALUATION CRITERIA

a. Selection committee

MADRID DESTINO will set up a Selection Committee comprising the curator of the situated research programme, a member of the Medialab Matadero team, a member of the Matadero Centre for Artists in Residence team, and two professionals from outside the institution. The Medialab Matadero team member will chair the committee.

The committee will have a secretary, a Madrid Destino legal services officer, who will attend committee meetings and record the results of the jury's deliberations. The secretary will be allowed to speak, but not to vote.

The Matadero Madrid Contracting Body, acting on the instructions of the Artistic Direction of Matadero Madrid, has the power to appoint committee members and designate new members and substitutes for each of them, as required.

External selection committee members from outside Madrid Destino, taking part in this invitation to participate, will be remunerated with the sum of FIVE HUNDRED EUROS (€500.00), to which any legally required withholdings will be applied.

The decisions of the Committee members will be made by the majority of participating members. In case of a tie, the person acting as chair shall have the casting vote.

The regulation of the Selection Committee is adjusted according to the rules established for collegiate bodies by Law 40/2015 of October 1 on the Legal Regime of the Public Sector. Exclusion due to non-compliance with the requirements, and evaluation, are the exclusive competence of the Selection Committee.

After eliminating those candidates who do not meet the participation requirements or have not submitted the required information and documentation in the entry form, as per section 10 of these rules and procedures, the Selection Committee will select three (3) winning projects from all those submitted. They will also select at least three (3) substitutes to replace any of the winning projects in the event of withdrawal or disqualification.

Exclusion due to non-compliance with the requirements, and evaluation, are the exclusive competence of the Selection Committee.

The Selection Committee may invite any candidates that it deems appropriate to present and explain their submitted projects.

The decision of this Selection Committee will be communicated on or after **10 October 2025**, through the websites www.medialab-matadero.es and www.mataderomadrid.org and to the email address provided in the applications submitted with the selected projects.

b. Assessment criteria

The track record and experience of the candidates and the quality of the submitted projects will be examined by the Selection Committee based on the following criteria:

- The candidates' track record in relation to Medialab Matadero's objectives and

methods of executing its lines of work.

- The relevance and depth of the research, its ability to operate beyond disciplinary barriers, its idiosyncrasy, and its connection with Medialab Matadero's objectives and various lines of work (see item 4).
- Ability to benefit from the unique features of a space such as Medialab Matadero while contributing to the program's development and objectives.
- Clarity of the proposal and feasibility in terms of its realisation and execution.
- Demonstrated competence in multidisciplinary research projects, team dynamics and tools.
- Familiarity with citizen initiatives and organisations in the city of Madrid, and with specific activities that promote coordination and dialogue with other projects within the city's cultural, technological or scientific fabric, or even the integration of social groups.
- Dynamics and innovative methods in the development of the project will be positively valued, along with the integration of new technologies and developing technologies forming part of the project's conceptualization.

Part or all of the invitation for applications may be declared null and void, at the discretion of the selection committee, without any right to appeal.

6 .- CONTRACTING AND FINANCIAL TERMS

Candidates whose projects have been selected will be contracted by MADRID DESTINO in accordance with the applicable contracting procedure under Law 9/2017 of 8 November 2017 on Public Sector Contracts.

Research projects will be developed at the risk and expense of the contractors, who will act with full freedom and autonomy, deciding on the organization of their means of production, without prejudice to the use of MADRID DESTINO's spaces, resources and means during the course of the research. The relationship between the Parties shall be that of independent contractors, without the contract constituting any form of partnership or joint venture, nor shall either Party be considered an agent, partner, employee or representative of the other.

The maximum contract price shall be FOURTEEN THOUSAND NINE HUNDRED AND FIFTY EUROS (€14,950.00), plus VAT and subject to the withholding of income tax if applicable, as a consideration for the development of the research project adapted to the Medialab Matadero program. The costs of all activities proposed by the contractor and accepted by the Medialab Matadero Program Manager shall be borne by Madrid Destino.

The payment of the agreed consideration for the provision of services, up to a maximum of €14,950.00, shall be made upon submission of the corresponding invoices in accordance with the following milestones:

- Forty per cent (40%) upon formalization of the corresponding contract or, if applicable, notification of award, for the rights to adapt the research project to the Medialab Matadero program, which shall be attached as an Annex to the contract together with the execution schedule.
- Thirty per cent (30%) upon delivery of a report on the research results within the first six months of the project, between 1 and 30 May 2026.

- The remaining thirty per cent (30%) upon completion of the research project and after submission of the project results and final report.

7. DURATION

The research project shall be developed over a period of **12 months** from the formalization of the contract, or in the case of contracts that do not require formalization, from the notification of the award.

The start of the execution of the services is scheduled for the first fortnight of December 2025, although the dates are subject to possible changes duly justified for scheduling reasons.

8.-UNDERTAKINGS OF THE CONTRACTOR AND OTHER TECHNICAL SPECIFICATIONS FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF THE RESEARCH PROJECTS

The technical specifications for the development of the research projects that are contracted, and that will be considered essential conditions are as follows:

- The results of the research project shall be published under a Creative Commons By-SA or similar license on www.medialab-matadero.es and www.mataderomadrid.org
- The contractor shall agree with MADRID DESTINO, with the consent of the Medialab Matadero Program Manager, on the periods and schedules in which the research will be carried out in person, in accordance with the schedules and programming of Medialab Matadero during the validity of the contract. The opening hours of the Matadero Madrid facilities are from Tuesday to Saturday from 10:00 to 21:00 hours.
- The research project shall coexist with the other projects selected in the same invitation to participate, in coordination with the Medialab Matadero Program Manager, with whom the contractor shall raise any issues that he or she considers to be of interest to the approach of the respective research project.
- The contractor must become actively involved in those activities of Medialab Matadero that his or her team deems essential in order to conduct research in line with the criteria set out in these rules and procedures. It is recommended that participants remain in Madrid throughout the research process. Specific exceptions may be agreed with the Head of Programming at Medialab Matadero when necessary for vital reasons or professional development.
- Coordination with the Medialab Matadero Program Manager shall be carried out through periodic meetings that will allow for the review, monitoring and evolution of the research project, to ensure that it is developed and adapted to Medialab Matadero's programming. To this end, the contractor shall propose the activities related to the research project that may be incorporated into the Medialab Matadero programming, for evaluation and acceptance by the Medialab Matadero Program Manager.

- Facilitate the documentation and dissemination of the research project. The contractor will provide MADRID DESTINO with textual, graphic, and/or visual content that serves to explain the research project and its development, in addition to the reports on the results and the final project report required as invoicing milestones.
- They must comply with the rules for the use of the Matadero Madrid facilities whenever they access them.
- The contractor will be subject to MADRID DESTINO's Code of Ethics, which is mandatory for all MADRID DESTINO contractors. The code is available at the following link on the website www.madrid-destino.com under the Transparency and Good Governance Section:

https://www.madrid-destino.com/sites/default/files/2020-12/C%C3%B3digo%20C3%A9tico_Madrid%20Destino_2.pdf.

In particular, project members must behave appropriately and avoid exhibiting racist, homophobic, transphobic, and/or sexist behaviour; any conduct that may violate human dignity will be grounds for immediate cancellation.

- The contractual relationship may be terminated in case of serious breach of any of the established essential conditions.

9. TRAVEL EXPENSES

Medialab will arrange and cover the cost of no more than one return trip for each selected participant living outside of Spain. In the case of groups, only the travel expenses of one member will be covered. Travel will be in economy class and always in accordance with the guidelines established by Madrid Destino.

10.- DOCUMENTS TO BE SUBMITTED AND APPLICATION DEADLINE

To submit the application, the following online form must be properly completed before **17 September 2025 at 23:59 CET**.

APPLICATION FORM:

TEAM: Full company or personal contact details (name of the entity and/or representative's full name, DNI, NIE, or passport, address, email, phone).

Attachments:

1. **Applicant's documentation:** The applicant's documentation must be attached in a single PDF file named with the entity or representative's name (authurname.pdf) in A4 format and should include:
 - Biographical summary and motivation letter (maximum 500 words)
 - Portfolio with previous or similar projects, (maximum 10 pages)
2. **Project documentation:** The project documentation must be attached in a single PDF

file named with the organization, representative, and the title of the research proposal (authorname_projectname.pdf) in A4 format and should include:

- Project title.
- Project Description (between 1,000 and 2,000 words), which must obligatorily include the following sections: background, approach, objectives, communities proposed to work with, work schedule, methodology, preliminary proposal for possible public activities, and expected results. Graphic material illustrating the project can be included, with a maximum of 10 images.
- Link to a video file with a personalized presentation and introduction to the proposed project, maximum 3 minutes.

Proposals can be submitted in either Spanish or English.

Submission of projects implies full acceptance of the terms of this invitation to participate and does not grant any rights to the participants.

Queries may be addressed to the following email address: info.m@medialab-matadero.es, indicating in the subject “Medialab Matadero 2025-2026 Research Projects Invitation.”

Notwithstanding the documentation required for participation, if the selection process is passed, the following documentation must be submitted before the start of the corresponding contracting procedure:

DOCUMENTATION TO BE SUBMITTED IF SELECTED

- Copy of the National ID Card (DNI), Foreigner’s ID (NIE), or valid passport of the signatory.
- Signed centre and space usage rules.
- Once the contract is formalized, or if required after the notification of the award, following the protocols of the Madrid Destino Security and Emergencies Department, the contractor will receive the following Occupational Risk Prevention documentation from the Self-Protection and Business Activities Coordination Subdirectorate of MADRID DESTINO:
 - Risk Assessment of the spaces that make up the Matadero cultural centre attached to Madrid Destino.
 - Emergency Measures for the four spaces that make up the Matadero cultural centre attached to Madrid Destino.
 - The Contractor must sign an acknowledgement of receipt and send it to the following address: seguridadprevencion@madrid-destino.com. CBA and Self-protection technician, Self-protection and CBA sub-directorate, Safety and Emergencies Department, Madrid Destino, Cultura, Turismo y Negocio, S.A., Calle Conde Duque 9-11, 1ª Planta. 28015, Madrid. Cultural and Sports Area. Madrid City Council.

DOCUMENTATION TO BE PRESENTED IN ORDER TO CONFIRM THE FIRST PAYMENT:

- Signed, stamped, and dated bank ownership certificate from the current year.
- Certificate of tax residence if it is outside Spain.

11.- INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

With MEDIALAB MATADERO, MADRID DESTINO aims to promote open knowledge and encourages the free use and reuse of the resulting works and prototypes from the working groups, workshops, and laboratories through the website [www.Medialab Matadero-matadero.es](http://www.Medialab-Matadero-matadero.es).

The texts (unless otherwise indicated) are licensed under a Creative Commons

Attribution 4.0 International license  which allows:

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- The only conditions are:
 - Acknowledgement, specifying the source of the information by means of the following formula displayed in a visible place: "Information obtained from the website www.medialab-matadero.es
 - Include the same obligation to acknowledge the source in the licensing terms and conditions of any derivative product that makes use of this information.

Do not distort the meaning of the reproduced information

- Avoid any form of presentation that might suggest that Madrid Destino or Madrid City Council supports or promotes the use made of the information thus disseminated.

Research results will be published under Creative Commons By-SA terms established at <http://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0/es/>. However, authors are entitled to license their content under any other free licence, to encourage wider dissemination, and must mention this in a way that is noticeable in the publication or work.

In this context, participants, by the simple act of submitting the research project to this invitation to participate, guarantee the originality and authorship of the submitted project, ensuring they legitimately hold all intellectual property rights over them. In this regard, they guarantee the peaceful use by Madrid Destino and third parties and explicitly exempt them from any liability for damages and/or losses that the breach of this guarantee by the participants may directly or indirectly cause, ensuring total indemnity.

If necessary, selected project candidates will be required to commit to granting, subscribing, and signing any necessary documents for the maximum and full effectiveness of the envisaged transmission or transfer of rights.

12. DATA PROTECTION

Madrid Destino guarantees that the personal data will be processed in accordance with current legislation and to this end informs that they will be included in a file owned by Madrid Destino under the following terms:

Data controller: Madrid Destino Cultura Turismo y Negocio, S.A., with a registered address in Madrid, calle Conde Duque, 9-11 de Madrid (postcode 28015).

Data Protection Officer: dpd@madrid-destino.com

Purposes: To manage participation in the “4th Open Call for the Selection of Three Situated Research Projects within the Annual Programme of Medialab Matadero at Matadero Madrid 2025-2026”, and fulfil the established relationship (registration, evaluation and selection of finalists, including the handling of the legal contract file, formalising and filing contracts and deeds, accountancy, compliance with tax obligations, invoicing, transparency and control).

Storage period: Storage will be limited to the period necessary to comply with the contractual relationship and for the statutory period for civil, criminal, administrative and any other actions that may arise from the activity or service provided.

Recipients: Web page and social network profiles of the winning applicants The Tax Agency and other public bodies, in compliance with tax, transparency and control obligations; financial entities for management of collections and payments; and legal authorities. Transparency obligations require Madrid Destino to publish, on its website, a list of all the contracts that it enters into, thereby stating the signatories, the purpose of the agreement, its term, any modifications made, the parties obliged to perform the services or activities and the agreed financial obligations.

Lawful basis: To participate in this open call, candidates are required to submit this data. Receipt of the questionnaire establishes its legitimacy.

Rights: The exercise of rights to access, rectification, erasure, data portability and restriction on data processing or objection can be requested by email to dpd@madrid-destino.com, with reference “Medialab Matadero/ Matadero” and identification of the applicant by means of an official document. You may also file a complaint with the Spanish Data Protection Agency (AEPD).

13. PARTICIPANT'S IMAGE RIGHTS

By submitting their project, candidates accept that if their project is selected and contracted, they may appear in images (photographs, videos, etc.) taken by MADRID DESTINO to document the research project for subsequent provision of information or running of promotions for the activity of Medialab Matadero, Matadero and/or Madrid Destino, on their respective websites and official social media profiles, and they authorise such use.

Likewise, they accept that their image may be used in catalogues or other documents compiling the activities of Medialab Matadero, Matadero or Madrid Destino.

All of this with provisos and limitation on uses and applications that infringe the right to honour in the terms set out in Organic Law 1/1982 of 5 May on the Civil Protection of the Right to Honour, to Personal and Family Privacy and to One's Own Image. Any other use outside the above scope is expressly excluded from this authorisation.

14. ACCEPTANCE OF THE RULES AND PROCEDURES

Participation in this open call implies full acceptance of the content of the rules and procedures governing it, as well as the agreements and the final decision of the Selection Committee Failure to comply with these rules and procedures will result in the exclusion

of the participant(s) from this open call.

15.- RESERVATIONS AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Madrid Destino reserves the right to take any initiative that contributes to the greater success of the open call, even if it is not regulated by these rules and procedures. This shall not entitle anyone to claim compensation.

Madrid Destino reserves the right to cancel this open call at any time and for any reason and to make modifications and/or add subsequent annexes to it, provided that these are justified and communicated publicly and in particular to the candidates.

Madrid Destino reserves the right to disqualify any participant who acts in an abusive and fraudulent manner, or who deceives, conceals or falsifies the participation data or in any way fails to comply with the conditions of these rules and procedures.

Madrid Destino shall not be responsible for any possible fortuitous eventualities that may affect the course of the call, such as technical traffic errors, internet connection failure or congestion.

16. CONFLICT RESOLUTION.

To resolve any issue or dispute arising out of the call, please write to Madrid Destino so that both parties may reach an amicable resolution.

Were such amicable settlement not to be reached, the parties, expressly waiving their own jurisdiction, submit themselves to the Courts and Tribunals of the city of Madrid.

Should you require further details, you may write to the email: info.m@medialab-matadero.es.

All queries will be resolved through this email address and will be published on the website www.medialab-matadero.es